WEB DEVELOPMENT · MIDTERM PROJECT PROPOSAL

Through My Lens

A Travel Photography Website

Student: Christina Fikru

Course: Web Development

Week 08 Presentation

HTML · CSS · Responsive Design · Hover Effects · Modals · Image Optimization

01

CONCEPT & THEME

throughmylens.com

The Concept

"Through My Lens" is a photography website that takes visitors on a visual journey across cities and countries. Each page is dedicated to a destination, showcasing a theme, not just a gallery, but a storytelling experience through images and place.

Immersive Visual Experience

photography, bold typography

TYPE: Travel Photography

Front-End Skills in Context

Every technical choice grid layout, hover effects, responsive breakpoints that serves the travel narrative.

PURPOSE: Storytelling

02 INSPIRATION & MOOD BOARD

1

National Geographic - ST. Croix

st.croix.com

Bold, full-bleed photography. Each page feels like a story.

KEY Focus

Full-bleed hero images · Minimal overlay text ·

2

City Strolling - East Village

citystrolling.com

walk in the city that guides with clean card-based layouts. Shows how to combine content + context beautifully with CSS grid.

KEY focus

Card grid system · Location labels · Clean sans-serif type

3

Cello - Portfolio

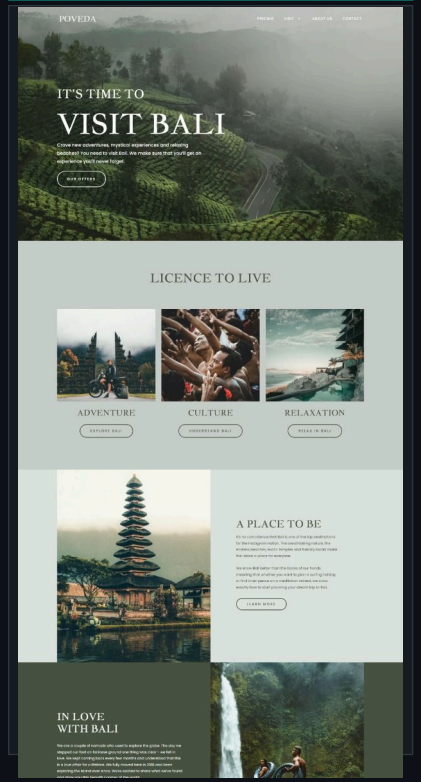
Masonry grid reference

masonry grid of a women playing cello

KEY Focus

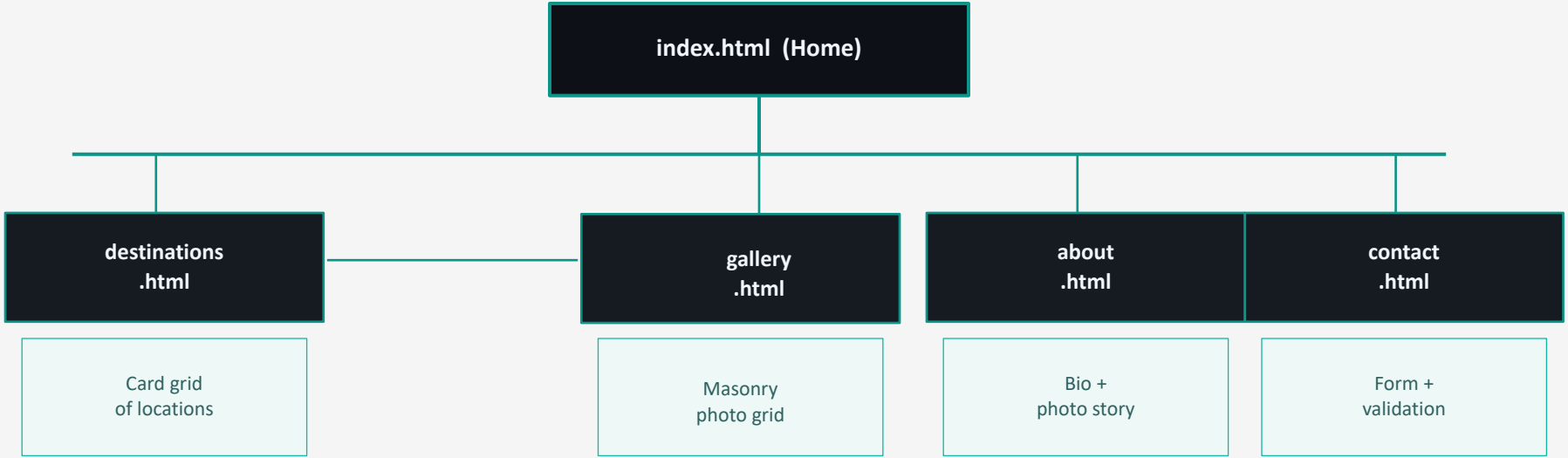
Masonry grid · CSS columns · Responsive image flow

03 MOOD BOARD



04 SITE STRUCTURE & SITEMAP

4-page architecture with clear navigation hierarchy



Nav

Sticky header shown across all pages

CSS

One stylesheet style.css

Media

Breakpoints at certain px

throughmylens.com

THROUGH MY LENS

Home | About | Destination | Gallery | Contact

Sticky nav
(position: sticky)

Explore the World

[Button] →

[FULL-WIDTH IMAGE]

object-fit: cover
on img

Featured Destinations

[Photo 1]

Destination Name

[Photo 2]

Destination Name

[Photo 3]

Destination Name

CSS Grid
3-col responsive

[Footer: Links · Social · Copyright]

06 WIREFRAME — DESTINATIONS & GALLERY

destinations.html

Nav Bar

Title *Title* *Title*

img 1 → 1 *img 2* *img 3*

hover: scale + overlay + modal trigger

Footer

MODAL WINDOW PATTERN

Click → overlay + centered modal box · ESC or × to close

gallery.html

Nav Bar

[Page Title]

img 1 ns) *img 2* *img 3*

hover: brightness + caption overlay

Footer

MASONRY LAYOUT

CSS columns: 3 → 2 → 1 at 768px & 480px breakpoints

Concepts & Skills Already Learned

HTML

HTML Structure & Semantics

Semantic tags: <header>, <nav>, <main>, <section>, <footer> — each page structured for accessibility and SEO. Proper document outline improves screen reader support.

```
<nav>
  <a href="/">Home</a>
</nav>
```

CSS

CSS Styling & Layout

Custom properties (variables), typography scale, color palette, card components, nav bars, and the overall visual identity of the site.

```
:root {
  --teal: #0D9488;
}
```

ALMOST!!

Responsive Design & Media Queries

Layout adapts from desktop → tablet → mobile. Grid reflows at key breakpoints. Elements show/hide with display:none depending on viewport.

```
@media (max-width: 768px) {
  .grid { columns: 2; }
}
```

IMG

Images & Basic CSS Layout

object-fit: cover for consistent image sizing. CSS box model, positioning basics, and background-image usage across components.

```
img {
  object-fit: cover;
}
```

Concepts Still Needed to Complete the Project

01

Currently Learning

Advanced Hover Effects/maybe shader code

Image cards should animate on hover: scale transform, brightness change, and caption slide-in overlay. Requires CSS and/or JS.

02

Currently Learning

Modals (Pop-up Windows)/ css only way in class

Destinations page will trigger a modal on card click, showing larger photo + details. Need JS to toggle .active class and CSS for overlay/modal box.

03

Currently Learning

CSS Flexbox / Grid Advanced/ display grid

Multi-column destination card layouts and masonry gallery grid require deeper understanding of CSS Grid areas, auto-fill, and minmax() for true responsiveness.

04

Image Sizing & Optimization

Convert images to WebP format, set correct srcset for responsive breakpoints, and use lazy loading for the gallery page to ensure fast load times.

05

HTML Forms & Validation/ final

Contact page requires a working form with labeled inputs, correct input types (email, textarea), and basic client-side validation using HTML5 attributes.

Roadmap before submitting

- ✓ Finalize Pinterest mood board
- ✓ Build HTML structure for all 5 pages
- ○ Apply base CSS: typography, colors, nav
- ○ Study & implement advanced hover effects (scale, brightness, overlay)
- ○ Build modal pop-up for Destinations page using JS class toggle
- ○ Add responsive media queries for tablet and mobile
- ○ Implement masonry gallery grid with CSS columns
- ○ Test resize behavior - verify hide/show elements work correctly

Have Photoshop installed by Week 07 · Suggest topics in class or via email!

Hover Effects · Modals · Media Queries

HOVER EFFECTS

```
.destination-card { overflow: hidden; }

.destination-card img {
  transition: transform 0.4s ease,
              filter 0.4s ease;
}

.destination-card:hover img {
  transform: scale(1.08);
  filter: brightness(0.65);
}

.card-overlay {
  opacity: 0;
  transition: opacity 0.3s ease;
}

.destination-card:hover .card-overlay {
  opacity: 1; /* slide caption in */
}
```

MODAL PATTERN (JS)

```
// Open
function openModal(imgSrc) {
  modal.querySelector("img").src = imgSrc;
  modal.classList.add("active");
}
// Close
modal.addEventListener("click", e => {
  if (e.target === modal) closeModal();
});
```

MEDIA QUERIES

```
/* Tablet */
@media (max-width: 768px) {
  .grid { grid-template-columns:
    repeat(2, 1fr); }
  .hero-text { font-size: 1.8rem; }
  .sidebar { display: none; } /* hide */
}
/* Mobile */
@media (max-width: 480px) {
  .grid { grid-template-columns: 1fr; }
  .mobile-nav { display: block; }
}
```

Modal, Z-Index, RWD Images & Videos

Image Modal

```
.destination-card { overflow: hidden; }

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}

.card-overlay {
  opacity: 0;
  transition: opacity 0.3s ease;
}

.destination-card:hover .card-overlay {
  opacity: 1; /* slide caption in */
}
```

https://www.w3schools.com/css/css3_images_modal.asp

Z-Index

```
.img{
   Position absolute;
   Left index: 0px;
   Right index: 0px;
   z-index: -1;
}
```

https://www.w3schools.com/css/css_z-index.asp

RWD images & Videos

```
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